They were random in nature and do not pertain to any particular system or sub-system.

The committee made the following observation: as our development is based on in-house drawings and as all the in-house drawings are available, the committee does not see any impact of some small number of drawings missing, on our programmes.

The documents/drawings are not marked as 'top secret', 'secret', 'confidential' or classified. ISRO follows an open door policy in regard to the issue of documents to the scientists. Since ISRO is a research-oriented organisation, any scientist wanting to study any document is free to go to the documentation cell and access the files.

Scientists could take copies on indent after entering the details in the documentation issue register. The fabrication division, where Sasikumaran worked, had issued 16,800 sheets. After Sasikumaran's transfer to Satellites Application Centre, Ahmedabad on 7 November 1994, all the copies of the drawings were found to be intact.

Nambi Narayanan, being a senior scientist, had access to the drawings, but at no stage any drawings/documents were found to have been issued to him. It is usual for scientists to take the documents. Drawings required for any meetings. Discussions to their houses for study purposes. In these circumstances, the allegation that Nambi Narayanan and Sasikumaran might have passed on the documents to a third party is found to be false.

TORTURE

The CBI report also noted that the accused were tortured by the Kerala Police and the IB, and recommended questioning of the officers. It said: in these circumstances, particularly in the context of allegation of torture and harassment made by the accused persons against the Kerala Police/IB, it is imperative to examine the Kerala Police officials/IB officials.